

AMD Buys ATI

The processor giant and the graphics goliath confirmed increasingly heating rumours on July 24, announcing their plans to join forces following a \$5.4 billion deal. Prepare yourself, world, for some incredible products in the future!



Rumour: Intel To Add 3G To Next-Gen Centrino

The next generation of Intel's Centrino platform, code-named "Santa Rosa," may well include 3G mobile phone network connectivity as well as the standard Wi-Fi, if allegedly leaked company roadmaps are to be believed



Enter

Sudhir Mishra
Director

Sudhir Mishra is a director, of *Chameli* and *Calcutta Mail* fame. He has been a producer, story writer, dialogue writer, and also a screenplay writer.

Technology to you is...

... a means by which you can express your thoughts and put your ideas across.

What gadgets do you use?

I have a computer at home, a laptop, a mobile, an iPod, and a DV camcorder.

What would be your dream gadget, and why?

A gadget by which you could do away with actors, singers and all... It ideally would be a combination of hardware and software, where I can pick a face and voice and then write the screenplay, select the scene, and do the whole movie sitting at home! Something like in an animation...

What do you do online?

I search for information. Yesterday, I happened to have been searching for a speech by William Faulkner—a literature Nobel Laureate. The Internet is a vast storehouse of information and you tend to waste time if you don't know where to search for what you want. I also check my mails regularly.

Any instance where technology has really helped you?

In 1998, when my wife was on a visit to Rishikesh, there was a landslide... If not for the mobile, it wouldn't have been easy to find out what was going on there.

BEYOND ALGORITHMS

Search Vistas

Search need not mean just Google or Yahoo! or MSN or any of the biggies. There exists no ideal search engine. For finding a quote by Winston Churchill, you're best off using something like Google. But for finding "deep" information on a subject like Bach's music, you might or might not be.

Consider a search site called PreFound.com, which explains the following about itself. We quote it because it is representative of "social" search in general:

"PreFound.com allows users to see what others have gathered by hand from the Web. Knowledgeable, interested people can identify relevant sites with greater accuracy than a search engine. You can leverage the work already done by others and build on that base. So search what has already been found on the Web! PreFound.com can cut through the clutter a typical Google search might return by adding the human element." Essentially, after you've found a bunch of useful links on a topic, you share that with the community.

One can't yet say how far such search will catch on, but the traditional-search companies—including Google and

Yahoo!—are listening, and with attention.

Del.icio.us is a site where you share bookmarks and thus discover new sites. Flickr is a photo-sharing site where you tag your pictures and contribute to the pool of photos people worldwide can search for and discover. And Yahoo! bought both

methodology. At Eurekster, results are weighted based on how many users click to a given site.

Then there's StumbleUpon, where one types in any topic of interest and clicks to find a random page of interest. Digg.com and Netscape.com invite visitors to recommend and vote on which items get to the top of the search list.

Where search involves finding answers to specific questions, we have Yahoo! Answers, and the paid-for Google Answers. Microsoft is working on something similar.

Chris Sherman, executive editor of Search Engine Watch, has said there's room for lots of players in the search race: "We've got the major players out there, but as people get better at learning how to navigate the Internet, they're not going to necessarily be looking for an answer from the titans anymore. They're going to be looking for more specialised or personalised information." But Shashi Seth, product manager for Google Co-op, has said specialisation will never take away much business from the major companies.

"They're all very niche players in the area of search," Seth said. "We still believe people will find core search fulfilling the bulk of their needs."

The "problem" is that so much of the information



these start-ups—which says something about the gaining importance of social search. Part of Google's foray into social-search territory has been its launch of Google Co-op, an information-sharing feature.

According to reports in the media, Steven Marder, co-founder of Eurekster Inc, said Yahoo!'s and Google's entry into social search validated their (Eurekster's) philosophy and

